AfriNuts Export
Odienné Côte d'Ivoire

AfriNuts Export – Core Certification Roadmap (2025–2028)

6th August 2025

To meet international compliance standards and market access requirements

Objective

To obtain internationally recognized certifications that enable AfriNuts Export to access premium B2B markets in the EU, US, and Gulf countries by ensuring compliance with food safety, ethical, and sustainability standards

Core Certifications & Strategic Value

Certification	Value & Market Benefit
Organic Certified (P., Sekou Hakim)	Labeling products "organic" in the EU, US, and GCC is required. Attracts health-conscious and premium buyers.
Fair Trade (B., Mohammed)	Ensures ethical sourcing and better labor conditions. Strong appeal in EU and US retail chains.
ISO 22000 (R., Cedric)	International standard for food safety management systems. Critical for processing and exports.
Halal Certified (TBD)	Required to access Muslim-majority markets (Gulf, Malaysia, Indonesia).
Rainforest Alliance (M., Kouyate)	Demonstrates sustainability and biodiversity protection. Preferred by conscious consumers in Western markets.

Certification Timeline & Roadmap

Year	Certification	Key Activities	Notes
2025	**Start Organic Pre-Assessment**	Select a certification body, begin recordkeeping, and adjust farm inputs.	Minimum 2–3 years for full status.
2025	**Fair Trade Assessment**	Partner with Fairtrade Africa, begin training for labor & wages.	Faster to achieve (6–12 months).
2026	**Begin ISO 22000 Setup**	Hire a consultant, draft a food safety manual, and train staff.	Needed before the processing plant opens.
2026	**Halal Certification Prep**	Train the team and align sourcing/processing with Halal requirements.	Can be pursued once the plant is near-ready.
2027	**Apply for Organic Certification**	After 2+ years of compliant farming.	Via ECOCERT or Control Union.
2027	**ISO 22000 Audit & Certify**	Full audit, corrective actions, and official certification.	
2028	**Rainforest Alliance**	Evaluate social & environmental compliance, community programs.	Complements Fair Trade and ESG goals.

Certification Bodies & Where to Apply

Certification	Certifying Bodies (Examples)	Website / Contact
Organic Certified	ECOCERT, Control Union	ecocert.com / controlunion.com
Fair Trade	Fairtrade Africa, FLO-CERT	fairtradeafrica.net
ISO 22000	SGS, Bureau Veritas, TÜV SÜD	sgs.com / bureauveritas.com
Halal Certified	Halal Control (EU), GIMDES (Turkey), IVAC (Ivory Coast)	gimdes.org, local religious councils
Rainforest Alliance	Rainforest Alliance (direct)	rainforest-alliance.org

Estimated Budget Range

Certification	Estimated Cost (USD)
Organic Certified	$5,000–$8,000 initial, + yearly renewal
Fair Trade	$3,000–$5,000 setup and audit
ISO 22000	$10,000–$15,000 (consulting + audit)
Halal Certified	$2,000–$4,000 (varies by body & country)
Rainforest Alliance	$3,000–$6,000 incl. training + assessment

Internal Preparation Required

- **Documentation**: Farm records, inputs, labor policies, food handling SOPs
- **Training**: Hygiene, organic standards, halal compliance, labor rights
- **Community**: Farmer welfare, biodiversity, local social programs
- **Team**: Appoint a certification coordinator per division

Immediate Requirements to Follow (2025–2026)

This phase is foundational for organic, fair trade, ISO, and Halal certification readiness.

1. Organic Certification Pre-Compliance

Start these now to ensure you're eligible for organic certification in 2–3 years:

- **No synthetic fertilizers, pesticides, or herbicides**
- Use **approved organic inputs** (get lists from ECOCERT or Control Union)
- Maintain **detailed logs**:
    - Land history (3-year chemical-free)
    - Input purchases and application records
    - Composting and irrigation methods
- **Soil management plan**:
    - Use crop rotation or intercropping (e.g., legumes)
    - Avoid erosion; plant cover crops
- **Buffer zones** from non-organic fields (e.g., 3-5 meters)
- **Start working with a local agronomist familiar with organic systems**

2. Fair Trade Compliance Readiness

Implement labor and community welfare practices early:

- **Fair wages** for workers and seasonal labor
- **No child labor or forced labor**
- Provide **protective equipment** (gloves, boots, etc.)
- Start **worker logs and contracts**
- Engage in **community consultations** (for ESG alignment)
- **Health and safety policies** on-site

- Encourage a **farm worker's feedback mechanism**

3. Food Safety Foundation (for ISO 22000 prep)

Even before processing starts, farm-level safety matters:

- Train field supervisors in **basic hygiene and handling**
- Establish **standard operating procedures (SOPs)** for:
    - Harvesting
    - Sorting
    - Storage (e.g., off-ground, dry, clean environments)
- Start recording **product traceability**:
    - Harvest date
    - Plot zone
    - Batch number (start simple with manual logs or Excel)
- Avoid mixing **contaminated or spoiled produce** with good batches.

4. Halal Practices (for future compliance)

Build early alignment for smooth Halal certification later:

- **Avoid cross-contamination** with non-Halal or alcohol-based inputs
- Train staff in **Halal awareness and hygiene**
- Document all farm inputs (fertilizers, pest control products)
- Engage with **Halal certifiers** during land prep or nursery stages, if possible.

5. ESG & Rainforest Alliance Principles (Optional, but valuable)

Good for investor confidence and long-term sustainability:

- Protect **trees, waterways, and wildlife corridors**
- Establish **firebreaks** and erosion control
- Develop a basic **environmental impact log**
- Plan for **community programs** (e.g., water wells, education, mosque)
- Document **community feedback sessions** or impact reviews

6. Start Building These Internal Tools

Tool	Purpose
Input Register	Organic tracking (fertilizers, seeds, compost)
Labor Log	Fair Trade and legal compliance
Harvest Log	Traceability and ISO prep
Community Engagement Log	ESG and Rainforest readiness
Pest/Disease Management Log	Shows transparency and organic control

7. Immediate Staff Training Needs

- Hygiene and contamination prevention
- Safe use of organic pest/disease control
- Labor rights & fair wage awareness
- Documentation and recordkeeping basics